Interactive Digital Art and Design SE608
Proof of Concept - Concept Alignment Year IV

Student Name:	Aoife Leahy	**Student Number:**	C00296873
Working Title:	Paths Unwritten		
PoC Date:	6/10/2026	**PoC Version:**	Version 1
How to use this document:			
1. Project Theme / Problem:	Paths Unwritten is an interactive 2D animated story that will focus on combining character design, illustration, animation and storytelling to create an engaging experience. The story will be presented through illustrated scenes, where the player will read the story and make choices that affect what happens next. These choices will influence the actions of the main character and can lead to different story paths and endings. This project will look at how animation and storytelling can work together to create an interactive experience. I will design my own characters and backgrounds, rig a 2D character and create animations for different parts of the story. I will use Godot to make the players' choices affect what happens next. The aim is to create a story that people can interact with and replay to see how different choices lead to different outcomes, while also developing my skills in art, animation and programming.		
2. Project Aim:	The aim of Paths Unwritten is to create an interactive 2D story in Godot where the player's choices affect the story, trigger character animations and lead to different outcomes.		
3. Project Objectives:	1. Design and create the characters, background and artwork for the story. 2. Create and rig a 2D character and make animations for different actions in the story. 3. Use Godot to build the story scenes and add buttons that allow the player to make choices. 4. Program the choices so they affect what happens next and lead to different story outcomes. 5. Add a restart option and test that the choices, animations and story paths work correctly.		
4. Target Users / Audience:	The target audience for Paths Unwritten is teenagers aged 12 and over who enjoy story-driven games, 2D animation and making choices that affect the outcome of a story. It is aimed at players who enjoy following characters, exploring different story events and discovering what happens when they make different decisions. The game will focus on its artwork, character animations and storytelling with the final storyline and content to be decided during development.		
5. Main User Requirements / Use Cases:	• Open the story and view an introductory book page explaining what the story is about and how to play. • Click the start button to open the book at the first page of the story. • Read the story through the pages of the book, with animated scenes showing the events as they happen. • Continue through one or more pages of the story until a decision needs to be made. • Select an option by clicking one of the buttons displayed at the bottom of the page or book. • View the animated scene that follows the selected option and continue reading the story. • Experience different story events and outcomes depending on the choices made. • Restart the story and make different choices to explore other possible story paths and endings.		

6. Required Features / Functional Requirements:

Essential features:

- Book layout with pages that display the story
- Introductory page explaining the story and how to play
- Start button to begin the story
- 2D animated scenes showing events in the story
- Character animations created using a 2d rigging method
- On screen choice buttons
- Mouse input to select options
- Restart option to play through again
- A playable and interactive story built in Godot
- Background music and sound effects

Optional features:

- Fade transitions between the pages or scenes
- Additional story paths and endings
- Page turning effect

7. Proposed Tools and Technologies:

Tool / Technology	Purpose in Project	Feature / Objective Supported	Why Suitable?
Godot Engine	Building the interactive story and designing the book layout.	Story pages, buttons, animations and page changes.	Provides the tools needed to create the interactive story.
C#	Writing the code that controls the story.	Mouse input, choice selection, branching story paths and restarting.	Allows me to program how the story responds to the players' choices.
Clip Studio Paint	Designing and drawing the characters, backgrounds and illustrations.	Character design, book pages and story artwork.	It allows me to create original 2D artwork for the story.
Adobe After Effects	Creating and editing animations and visual effects.	Animated story scenes, character movements and transitions between the scenes.	Provides tools for creating animations and adding visual effects to the story.
Spine 2D	Preparing the character for animation.	Character movements and animated scenes.	Rigging will make it easier to animate the character.
Github	Backing up the project.	Project management.	Allows me to track any changes that I make throughout the project and provides backup.

8. Project Alignment Matrix:

Project Objective	Required Feature	Tool / Technology	PoC Evidence / Test	Expected Final Outcome
Create 2D character animations	Animated characters and scenes showing events in the story	Adobe After Effects	A character animation playing correctly within a story scene	Animated scenes that bring the story to life
Implement player choices	Choice buttons that lead to different story events	Godot/c#	Selecting different choices displays the correct next	A branching story where player decisions affect what

			scene	happens next
Implement story progression	Ability to move between story pages and scenes	Godot/c#	Test that the player can progress through the story correctly	A complete story that progresses from the introduction to its different outcomes
Create an interactive storybook	Book layout, story text, illustrations and a start button	Godot/c#	Start button opens the first page of the story	A working interactive book that allows the player to read the story
Create the artwork for the story	Original character designs, backgrounds and illustrated book pages	Clip studio paint	Artwork imported and displayed correctly in Godot	A consistent visual style across the book and scenes

9. PoC Demonstration / Evidence:

For my Poc demonstration, I will create a simple book page in Godot with some story text on it. I will add a button that allows the player to move to another page. This will demonstrate the basic layout of my interactive story and show that I can use C# to make the pages work.

10. Technology Suitability / Alternatives:

Requirement	Proposed Approach / Tool	Alternative Considered	Reason for Final Choice
Artwork creation	Clip Studio Paint	Adobe Photoshop	Clip Studio Paint is suitable for drawing the characters, illustrations and backgrounds for the story and I have used it more times than photoshop.
Animation creation	Adobe After Effects	Blender	I chose After Effects, as I have used it more than blender and know more about it due to my work placement.
Game engine	Godot	Ren'py	I chose Godot because it gives me more freedom to develop the project, including the features such as character movement, animations, etc.
Story coding	C#	GDScript	I chose C# because it is compatible with Godot and is able for simple game mechanics.

11. Scope - Core vs Optional Features:

Feature	Priority	Reason / Objective Supported	Include in PoC?
Interactive book layout	Must have	Provides the main layout for displaying the story	Yes
Story text and illustrations	Must have	Allows the player to read the story and view the artwork.	Yes

Page navigation button	Must have	Allows the player to move from the introductory page to the story page, etc.	Yes
Character animations	Must have	Shows the character moving during a story scene so the player can see what's happening	Yes
Branching choices	Must have	Allows the players' decisions to change what happens next in the story.	Yes

12. Feasibility Assessment:

Area	Question to Consider	Assessment / Evidence
Technical	Can the required features be built?	Yes. The project will use a simple book layout, basic character animations and choice buttons that lead to different story outcomes. These features can be developed in Godot using C#.
Time	Can a meaningful version be completed?	Yes. I will focus on creating a basic interactive story with a small number of pages and simple branching choices before adding more features.
Skills	Can the required skills be developed in time?	Yes. I have experience with digital art and design. I will need to develop my skills in Godot and C#, but I can learn these while building the project.
Resources	Are software, hardware and data available?	Godot, C#, Clip Studio Paint and Adobe After Effects are the main tools I plan to use, and I have already installed them.
Evaluation	Can success be demonstrated or measured?	Yes. Success can be demonstrated through a working prototype where the player can read a story page and make a choice that changes what happens next.

13. Risks and Plan B:

Risk / Uncertainty	What It Affects	Mitigation	Plan B / Alternative
Programming is more difficult than expected	Choice buttons and branching story paths	Keep the code simple and build 2 choices leading to either one or two outcomes.	Reduce the number of choices and story branches while keeping the main idea.
Time becomes limited	Overall project scope	Complete all the must have basic features before adding anything else	Remove any features that are additional or non-essential and stick to the basic features
Artwork takes longer than expected	Story pages, backgrounds and character design	Create only the artwork needed for the main story scenes first	Reuse any backgrounds and illustrations that I already have or

	throughout the multiple pages where needed
14. PoC Outcome / Decision:	*Select one outcome and justify the decision below:* ☐ Proceed - the concept and proposed approach are suitable. ☐ Proceed with changes - the concept is feasible, but changes are required. ☐ Reconsider - the current concept or approach requires significant revision. *Justification: [Explain the decision in 3-5 sentences.]*
15. Required Changes Before Full Development:	*List the specific changes that must be made as a result of the PoC. Examples: change technology, reduce scope, replace an input method, redefine a feature, modify the user flow, add a Plan B, or strengthen the technical component.*
16. Next Steps:	*List the next 3-5 concrete development tasks in priority order. Each task should follow logically from the PoC decision and the revised project direction.*
17. Supporting Material / References:	*Provide links or references to supporting research, technical documentation, comparable systems, design references, GitHub repository, screenshots, diagrams or short demonstration videos used to justify the PoC decisions.*
Student declaration: The information in this Proof of Concept reflects the current proposed direction of the FYP and the evidence available at this stage. Signed: Date:	
For Office / Supervisor Use Only	
PoC reviewed:	*[Supervisor notes]*
Main issues / conditions:	*[Supervisor notes]*
Approved direction / required changes:	*[Supervisor notes]*
Supervisor:	*[Supervisor notes]*
Signed / Date:	*[Supervisor notes]*